

Evergreen Marine (2603 TT)

Upgrade to Buy: Back in the spotlight

- ◆ Geopolitical disruption likely to tighten the demand-supply outlook for container shipping in 2026
- ◆ Evergreen is better positioned vs peers in markets with rising spot rates and elevated fuel prices given its fuel-efficient fleet
- ◆ Upgrade to Buy (from Reduce); TP to TWD280 (from TWD170); re-rating driven by rising spot rates and widespread congestion

4Q25 results slight miss vs consensus: Evergreen's 4Q25 revenue was in-line with consensus, while net profit was 8% below consensus but 14% better than HSBCe. EBIT margin was 9.4%, down from 21.7% in 3Q25 as freight rates normalised further, faring better vs Maersk Ocean down 18ppts to -1.8%. Evergreen declared a TWD16 dividend per share, equivalent to 50% payout, or c8% current yield. In the first two months in 2026, Evergreen reported a 23% y-o-y decline in revenues, vs 21-29% decline in CCFI and SCFI average rates.

Geopolitical disruptions change the 2026 container shipping outlook: At the start of 2026, we had expected another year of softer earnings for container shipping, as the headline demand-supply balance suggested continued overcapacity. The escalation in the Middle East conflict in late February has subsequently changed our view on the sector outlook for 2026. The conflict has created disruptions to global supply chains, and if not resolved swiftly within weeks we expect widespread port congestion across Europe and Asia that will ultimately absorb active tonnage from the market, leading to higher spot freight rates. Indeed, the Shanghai Containerised Freight Index has risen 28% since late February, with Asia-Europe routes surging by as much as 14%. In addition, elevated geopolitical tensions in the region have likely pushed out the timeline for resumption of the Red Sea route beyond 2026 (vs our previous assumption of mid-2026), reducing the likelihood of additional capacity being released. Combining both, we expect demand-supply to remain tight throughout 2026, providing support to higher freight rates.

Evergreen extending its strengths: Evergreen runs a young and fuel-efficient fleet that has more scrubbers installed than peers and exposure to the spot freight rate markets. We expect it to benefit from rising spot freight rates, and further extend its cost leadership and margin superiority vs peers as fuel prices remain elevated in the near term.

Raise 2026-27 EPS estimates 60-67% on near-term freight rate momentum. We expect an EBIT margin of 14.5% in 2026, vs 19.1% in 2025, but still better than peers (Maersk Ocean at -4.7% and OOIL at 8.6%), reflecting Evergreen's strong positioning. Our 2026-27e EPS estimates are still 14% and 4% below consensus, respectively.

Upgrade to Buy (from Reduce); raise TP to TWD280 (from TWD170) on target PB of 1.0x (from 0.6x). We believe the higher multiple better reflects the sector demand-supply outlook in 2026, and near-term positive spot freight rate momentum due to disruptions. Evergreen stock has gained 11% YTD, lagging Asian peers up 16-23% to 0.9 PB. We think Evergreen's share price should play catch up as disruption-led freight rate momentum continues.

Equities Marine

Taiwan



UPGRADE TO BUY

TARGET PRICE (TWD)

280.00

PREVIOUS TARGET (TWD)

170.00

SHARE PRICE (TWD)

207.50

(as of 13 Mar 2026)

UPSIDE/DOWNSIDE

+34.94%

MARKET DATA

Market cap (TWDm)	449,246	Free float	75%
Market cap (USDm)	14,079	BBG	2603 TT
3m ADTV (USDm)	91	RIC	2603.TW

FINANCIALS AND RATIOS (TWD)

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
HSBC EPS	29.73	20.06	16.61	12.70
HSBC EPS (prev)	29.55	12.52	9.97	na
Change (%)	0.6	60.3	66.6	na
Consensus EPS	32.50	22.51	13.96	-
PE (x)	6.98	10.34	12.50	16.34
Dividend yield (%)	7.71	4.93	4.08	3.12
EV/EBITDA (x)	3.73	4.89	5.49	6.39
ROE (%)	11.46	7.78	6.31	4.72

52-WEEK PRICE (TWD)



Source: LSEG IBES, HSBC estimates

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This report must be read with the disclosures and the analyst certifications in the Disclosure appendix, and with the Disclaimer, which forms part of it.

Issuer of report: The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited

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Financials & valuation: Evergreen Marine

Buy

Financial statements

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
Profit & loss summary (TWDm)				
Revenue	379,069	356,379	345,425	338,286
EBITDA	111,012	91,454	84,919	76,241
Depreciation & amortisation	-38,741	-39,615	-42,274	-44,910
Operating profit/EBIT	72,271	51,838	42,645	31,331
Net interest	2,227	1,311	-525	-1,051
PBT	82,860	58,717	47,921	36,329
HSBC PBT	79,845	58,717	47,921	36,329
Taxation	-12,613	-13,385	-10,403	-7,645
Net profit	68,581	44,255	36,628	28,003
HSBC net profit	65,566	44,255	36,628	28,003

Cash flow summary (TWDm)

Cash flow from operations	101,202	70,129	72,964	66,813
Capex	-21,900	-60,800	-60,800	-60,800
Cash flow from investment	-108,997	-72,805	-73,522	-74,059
Dividends	-70,364	-34,641	-22,128	-18,314
Change in net debt	96,501	37,420	22,795	25,674
FCF equity	82,133	9,329	12,164	6,013

Balance sheet summary (TWDm)

Intangible fixed assets	0	0	0	0
Tangible fixed assets	523,418	559,982	593,906	625,214
Current assets	233,728	203,546	189,371	173,357
Cash & others	174,366	146,946	134,152	118,477
Total assets	894,332	905,510	930,295	950,876
Operating liabilities	123,086	113,573	112,967	113,178
Gross debt	165,742	175,742	185,742	195,742
Net debt	-8,624	28,796	51,590	77,265
Shareholders' funds	563,818	573,433	587,933	597,622
Invested capital	459,694	503,009	536,158	566,916

Ratio, growth and per share analysis

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
Y-o-y % change				
Revenue	-18.23	-5.99	-3.07	-2.07
EBITDA	-42.68	-17.62	-7.15	-10.22
Operating profit	-53.27	-28.27	-17.73	-26.53
PBT	-54.06	-29.14	-18.39	-24.19
HSBC EPS	-47.21	-32.50	-17.24	-23.55

Ratios (%)

Revenue/IC (x)	0.89	0.74	0.66	0.61
ROIC	14.44	8.31	6.43	4.49
ROE	11.46	7.78	6.31	4.72
ROA	8.24	5.45	4.51	3.48
EBITDA margin	29.29	25.66	24.58	22.54
Operating profit margin	19.07	14.55	12.35	9.26
EBITDA/net interest (x)			161.66	72.55
Net debt/equity	-1.47	4.82	8.43	12.41
Net debt/EBITDA (x)	-0.08	0.31	0.61	1.01
CF from operations/net debt		243.54	141.43	86.47

Per share data (TWD)

EPS Rep (diluted)	31.09	20.06	16.61	12.70
HSBC EPS (diluted)	29.73	20.06	16.61	12.70
DPS	16.00	10.22	8.46	6.47
Book value	260.42	264.86	271.56	276.03

Valuation data

Year to	12/2025a	12/2026e	12/2027e	12/2028e
EV/sales	1.09	1.26	1.35	1.44
EV/EBITDA	3.73	4.89	5.49	6.39
EV/IC	0.90	0.89	0.87	0.86
PE*	6.98	10.34	12.50	16.34
PB	0.80	0.78	0.76	0.75
FCF yield (%)	18.28	2.08	2.71	1.34
Dividend yield (%)	7.71	4.93	4.08	3.12

* Based on HSBC EPS (diluted)

ESG metrics

Environmental Indicators	12/2023a	Governance Indicators	12/2025a
GHG emission intensity*	1,482.2	No. of board members	9
Energy intensity*	3,832.1	Average board tenure (years)	n/a
CO ₂ reduction policy	Yes	Female board members (%)	11.11
Social Indicators		Board members independence (%)	33.33
Employee costs as % of revenues	6.73		
Employee turnover (%)	3.74		
Diversity policy	Yes		

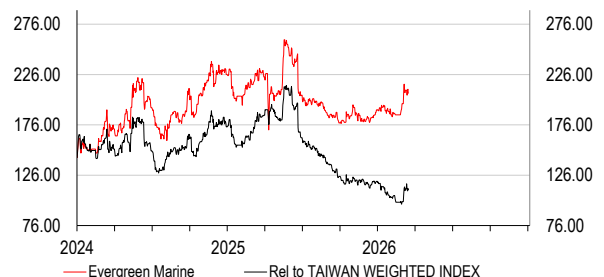
Source: Company data, HSBC

* GHG intensity and energy intensity are measured in kg and kWh respectively against revenue in USD '000s

Issuer information

Share price (TWD)	207.50	Free float	75%
Target price (TWD)	280.00	Sector	Marine
RIC (Equity)	2603.TW	Country/Region	Taiwan
Bloomberg (Equity)	2603 TT	Analyst	Parash Jain
Market cap (USDm)	14,079	Contact	+852 2996 6717

Price relative



Source: HSBC

Note: Priced at close of 13 Mar 2026

Exhibit 1. Evergreen: 4Q25/2025 results

(TWDm)	4Q25	4Q24	% y-o-y	3Q25	% q-o-q	HSBC 4Q25e	vs. HSBC	BBG Cons.	vs BBG Cons.	2025	2024	% y-o-y	HSBC 2025e	vs HSBC 2025e	BBG Cons.	vs. BBG Cons.
Revenues	85,694	115,812	-26%	96,921	-12%	77,435	11%	84,582	1%	379,069	463,568	-18%	369,248	3%	382,188	-1%
Operating costs ex DD&A	(70,371)	(73,409)	-4%	(65,451)	8%	(59,784)	18%			(268,057)	(269,902)	-1%	(257,144)	4%		
EBITDA	15,323	42,403	-64%	31,469	-51%	17,651	-13%			111,012	193,666	-43%	112,104	-1%		
Depreciation	(7,237)	(10,203)	-29%	(10,472)	-31%	(10,606)	-32%			(38,741)	(39,007)	-1%	(42,436)	-9%		
Operating costs	(77,608)	(83,611)	-7%	(75,923)	2%	(70,390)	10%	(72,382)	7%	(306,797)	(308,909)	-1%	(299,580)	2%	(303,232)	0
EBIT	8,086	32,200	-75%	20,997	-61%	7,044	15%	12,201	-34%	72,271	154,659	-53%	69,668	4%	78,956	-8%
Net finance costs and other incomes	986	1,734	-43%	1,069	-8%	1,311	-25%			3,007	6,387	-53%	5,522	-46%		
Associates and JV	1,055	1,139	-7%	1,231	-14%	1,134	-7%			4,567	4,040	13%	4,646	-2%		
Non-recurring items	412	6,561	-94%	1,756	-77%	-	n/m			3,015	15,264	-80%	413	629%		
PBT (reported)	10,539	41,633	-75%	25,053	-58%	9,490	11%	11,513	-8%	82,860	180,350	-54%	80,250	3%	91,387	-9%
Income tax	(1,558)	(9,732)	-84%	(2,977)	-48%	(1,472)	6%			(12,613)	(36,366)	-65%	(12,527)	1%		
PAT	8,981	31,901	-72%	22,076	-59%	8,018	12%			70,248	143,984	-51%	67,723	4%		
Minority interests	(463)	(1,202)	62%	(330)	-40%	(926)	50%			(1,667)	(4,531)	63%	(2,131)	22%		
Reported PAT to equity holders	8,518	30,699	-72%	21,746	-61%	7,091	20%	8,777	-3%	68,581	139,453	-51%	65,592	5%	73,027	-6%
HSBC Recurring PAT to equity holders	8,106	24,138	-66%	19,990	-59%	7,091	14%	8,777	-8%	65,566	124,189	-47%	65,178	1%	73,027	-10%
Key ratios																
EBITDA margin (%)	17.9%	36.6%	-18.7 ppt	32.5%	-14.6 ppt	22.8%	-4.9 ppt			29.3%	41.8%	-12.5 ppt	30.4%	-1.1 ppt		
EBIT margin (%)	9.4%	27.8%	-18.4 ppt	21.7%	-12.2 ppt	9.1%	0.3 ppt	14.4%	-5.0 ppt	19.1%	33.4%	-14.3 ppt	18.9%	0.2 ppt	20.7%	-1.6 ppt
Effective tax rate	14.8%	23.4%	-8.6 ppt	11.9%	2.9 ppt	15.5%	-0.7 ppt			15.2%	20.2%	-4.9 ppt	15.6%	-0.4 ppt		

Note: Depreciation and non-recurring items are based on HSBC estimates as the company did not report detailed financial items.

Source: Company data, HSBC estimates

Changes to our estimates

We raise our 2026 net profit estimate by 60%, reflecting higher container tariff growth on near-term freight rate momentum and thereby improved EBIT margin.

We also introduce our 2028e in this report, which are largely based on normalized growth assumptions for volumes and tariffs given limited visibility on specific market dynamics at that horizon.

2. Evergreen: Changes to our forecasts (2026e-28e)

(TWDm)	New			Old			Change		
	2026e	2027e	2028e	2026e	2027e	2028e	2026e	2027e	2028e
Container volume growth	3.5%	3.0%	3.0%	3.0%	3.0%	n.a.	0.5 ppt	0.0 ppt	n.a.
Container tariff growth	-9.0%	-6.0%	-5.0%	-14.5%	-3.0%	n.a.	5.5 ppt	-3.0 ppt	n.a.
Financials									
Turnover	356,379	345,425	338,286	326,646	326,471	n.a.	9%	6%	n.a.
EBITDA	91,454	84,919	76,241	71,980	67,012	n.a.	27%	27%	n.a.
EBIT	51,838	42,645	31,331	29,096	22,561	n.a.	78%	89%	n.a.
HSBC net profit (adjusted)	44,255	36,628	28,003	27,605	21,985	n.a.	60%	67%	n.a.
HSBC recurring EPS (TWD)	20.06	16.61	12.70	12.52	9.97	n.a.	60%	67%	n.a.
Margin assumptions									
EBITDA margin	25.7%	24.6%	22.5%	22.0%	20.5%	n.a.	3.6 ppt	4.1 ppt	n.a.
EBIT margin	14.5%	12.3%	9.3%	8.9%	6.9%	n.a.	5.6 ppt	5.4 ppt	n.a.
ROE	7.8%	6.3%	4.7%	4.8%	3.8%	n.a.	3.0 ppt	2.5 ppt	n.a.
ROIC	8.3%	6.4%	4.5%	5.1%	3.9%	n.a.	3.2 ppt	2.6 ppt	n.a.

Source: HSBC estimates

HSBC estimates vs consensus

Our 2026-27 EBIT estimates are now 4-14% below Bloomberg consensus, as we are more cautious on demand-supply fundamentals.

3. Evergreen: HSBC estimates vs consensus

(TWDm)	EBIT			EPS (TWD)		
	HSBC	Consensus	Difference	HSBC	Consensus	Difference
2026e	51,838	60,468	-14%	20.06	20.99	-4%
2027e	42,645	44,390	-4%	16.61	17.77	-7%

Source: Bloomberg, HSBC estimates

Valuation and risks

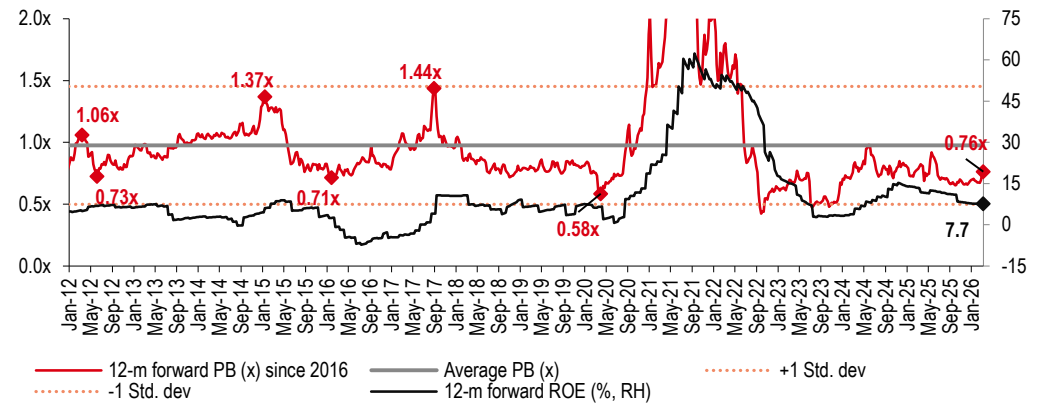
**Upgrade to Buy (from Reduce);
raise TP to TWD280 (from
TWD170)**

We base our PB valuation on 2026e BVPS and apply a target PB multiple of 1.0x (from 0.60x), which is the average since mid-2011 (from 0.8 SD below its average since mid-2011). We apply our target P/B multiple to our BVPS of cTWD265 (from cTWD262). The higher multiple reflects a better sector demand-supply outlook in 2026, and near-term positive spot freight rate momentum due to disruptions. Evergreen stock has gained 11% YTD, lagging Asian peers up 16-26% to 0.9 PB. We expect Evergreen's share price to play catch up as disruption-led freight rate momentum continues. We do not apply an ESG premium given its relative ESG positioning vs peers.

Based on the above assumptions and adding back the 2025 final dividend, we arrive at a target price of TWD280, which implies c35% upside. We upgrade Evergreen to Buy (from Reduce)

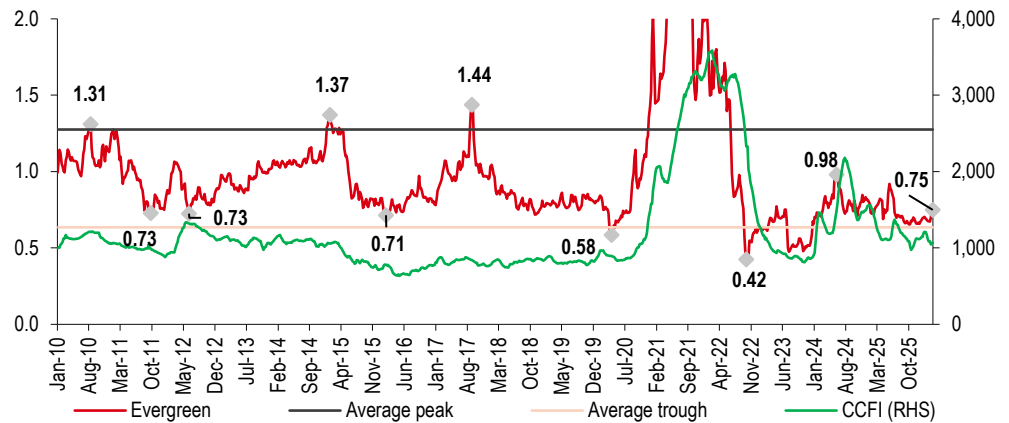
Downside risks: Shorter-than-expected congestion and supply chain inefficiencies; milder-than-expected rally in freight rates; weaker-than-expected consumption demand from world ex-US; and weaker-than-expected US retail consumption demand.

4. Evergreen: Consensus 12-month forward PB-ROE trend



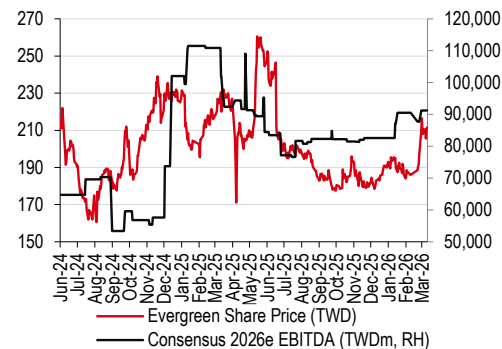
Note: Priced as of 13 Mar 2026. Source: LSEG Datastream

5. Evergreen: The stock is trading close to the average trough valuation



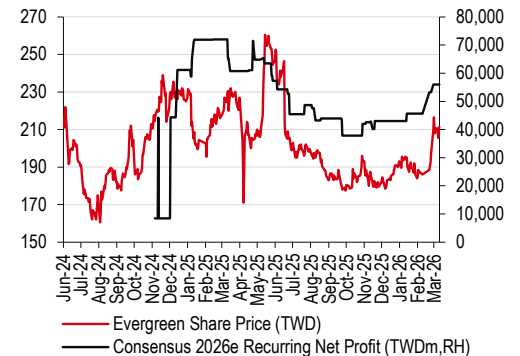
Note: Priced as of 13 Mar 2026, CCFI data as of 13 Mar 2026. Source: LSEG Datastream

6. Evergreen: share price vs consensus 2026e EBITDA estimate



Source: Bloomberg. Priced as of 13 Mar 2026.

7. Evergreen: share price vs consensus 2026e recurring NP estimate



Source: Bloomberg. Priced as of 13 Mar 2026.

8. Global container shipping valuation summary

	Bloomberg		HSBC	Share	Target	Mkt cap	Turnover	Free	PB (x)		EV/EBITDA (x)		ROE (%)		PE (x)		Yield (%)		Net debt to	Share price performance			
Company	ticker	Curr	rating	price	price	(USDm)	(USDm)	float (%)	2025e	2026e	2025e	2026e	2025e	2026e	2025e	2026e	2025e	2026e	equity (x)	1M	6M	1Y	YTD
AP Moller Maersk	MAERSKB DC	DKK	Buy	16,230	17,500	38,932	48.2	51%	0.7	0.7	3.8	5.4	4.6%	0.9%	14.8	70.2	3.0%	0.4%	-0.1x	-4%	21%	44%	11%
COSCO Shipping-H	1919 HK	HKD	Reduce	15.35	11.00	34,251	46.7	94%	0.9	0.9	2.0	3.2	12.3%	5.6%	7.4	15.9	6.7%	3.1%	-0.4x	1%	21%	50%	16%
COSCO Shipping-A	601919 CH	CNY	Reduce	15.78	13.00	34,251	229.7	36%	1.1	1.0	2.0	3.2	12.3%	5.6%	8.7	18.6	5.7%	2.7%	-0.4x	1%	10%	25%	5%
OOIL	316 HK	HKD	Hold	142.70	130.00	13,011	21.5	15%	0.9	0.9	3.2	3.6	10.8%	7.7%	8.4	11.5	6.3%	4.3%	-0.5x	-1%	16%	50%	23%
Evergreen Marine	2603 TT	TWD	Buy	207.50	280.00	14,079	90.7	75%	0.8	0.8	3.7	4.9	11.5%	7.8%	7.0	10.3	7.6%	4.8%	-0.2x	2%	14%	7%	11%
Hapag Lloyd	HLAG GR	EUR	Reduce	133.40	100.00	26,990	3.1	14%	1.2	1.2	8.2	8.7	3.3%	1.3%	35.3	92.9	1.5%	0.5%	0.1x	-4%	12%	-3%	13%
SITC	1308 HK	HKD	Hold	33.70	31.00	11,626	20.3	47%	4.7	4.3	8.3	11.1	48.5%	32.4%	9.9	14.1	8.9%	7.2%	-0.1x	2%	16%	105%	30%

Note: Turnover is based on the average over the past three months; Net debt to equity is as of 2024-end. Share price performance refers to total return, which included dividends. Priced at close of 13 Mar 2026.

Source: Bloomberg, LSEG Datastream, HSBC estimates

Disclosure appendix

Analyst Certification

The following analyst(s), economist(s), or strategist(s) who is(are) primarily responsible for this report, including any analyst(s) whose name(s) appear(s) as author of an individual section or sections of the report and any analyst(s) named as the covering analyst(s) of a subsidiary company in a sum-of-the-parts valuation certifies(y) that the opinion(s) on the subject security(ies) or issuer(s), any views or forecasts expressed in the section(s) of which such individual(s) is(are) named as author(s), and any other views or forecasts expressed herein, including any views expressed on the back page of the research report, accurately reflect their personal view(s) and that no part of their compensation was, is or will be directly or indirectly related to the specific recommendation(s) or views contained in this research report: Parash Jain, Deepak Maurya, CFA and Bruce Chu, CFA

Important disclosures

Equities: Stock ratings and basis for financial analysis

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From 23rd March 2015 HSBC has assigned ratings on the following basis:

The target price is based on the analyst's assessment of the stock's actual current value, although we expect it to take six to 12 months for the market price to reflect this. When the target price is more than 20% above the current share price, the stock will be classified as a Buy; when it is between 5% and 20% above the current share price, the stock may be classified as a Buy or a Hold; when it is between 5% below and 5% above the current share price, the stock will be classified as a Hold; when it is between 5% and 20% below the current share price, the stock may be classified as a Hold or a Reduce; and when it is more than 20% below the current share price, the stock will be classified as a Reduce.

Our ratings are re-calibrated against these bands at the time of any 'material change' (initiation or resumption of coverage, change in target price or estimates).

Upside/Downside is the percentage difference between the target price and the share price.

Prior to this date, HSBC's rating structure was applied on the following basis:

For each stock we set a required rate of return calculated from the cost of equity for that stock's domestic or, as appropriate, regional market established by our strategy team. The target price for a stock represented the value the analyst expected the stock to reach over our performance horizon. The performance horizon was 12 months. For a stock to be classified as Overweight, the potential return, which equals the percentage difference between the current share price and the target price, including the forecast dividend yield when indicated, had to exceed the required return by at least 5 percentage points over the succeeding 12 months (or 10 percentage points for a stock classified as Volatile*). For a stock to be classified as Underweight, the stock was expected to underperform its required return by at least 5 percentage points over the succeeding 12 months (or 10 percentage points for a stock classified as Volatile*). Stocks between these bands were classified as Neutral.

*A stock was classified as volatile if its historical volatility had exceeded 40%, if the stock had been listed for less than 12 months (unless it was in an industry or sector where volatility is low) or if the analyst expected significant volatility. However, stocks which we did not consider volatile may in fact also have behaved in such a way. Historical volatility was defined as the past month's average of the daily 365-day moving average volatilities. In order to avoid misleadingly frequent changes in rating, however, volatility had to move 2.5 percentage points past the 40% benchmark in either direction for a stock's status to change.

Rating distribution for long-term investment opportunities

As of 31 December 2025, the distribution of all independent ratings published by HSBC is as follows:

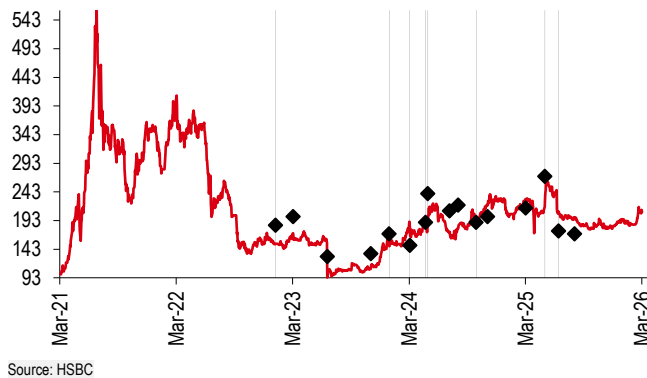
Buy	57%	(12% of these provided with Investment Banking Services in the past 12 months)
Hold	37%	(13% of these provided with Investment Banking Services in the past 12 months)
Sell	6%	(5% of these provided with Investment Banking Services in the past 12 months)

For the purposes of the distribution above the following mapping structure is used during the transition from the previous to current rating models: under our previous model, Overweight = Buy, Neutral = Hold and Underweight = Sell; under our current model Buy = Buy, Hold = Hold and Reduce = Sell. For rating definitions under both models, please see “Stock ratings and basis for financial analysis” above.

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Share price and rating changes for long-term investment opportunities

Evergreen Marine (2603.TW) share price performance TWD Vs HSBC rating history



Rating & target price history

From	To	Date	Analyst
Hold	Buy	18 Jan 2023	Parash Jain
Buy	Hold	09 Jan 2024	Parash Jain
Hold	Reduce	14 Mar 2024	Parash Jain
Reduce	Hold	03 May 2024	Parash Jain
Hold	Buy	10 May 2024	Parash Jain
Buy	Hold	08 Oct 2024	Parash Jain
Hold	Buy	12 May 2025	Parash Jain
Buy	Reduce	24 Jun 2025	Parash Jain
Target price	Value	Date	Analyst
Price 1	185.00	18 Jan 2023	Parash Jain
Price 2	200.00	14 Mar 2023	Parash Jain
Price 3	130.00	30 Jun 2023	Parash Jain
Price 4	135.00	13 Nov 2023	Parash Jain
Price 5	170.00	09 Jan 2024	Parash Jain
Price 6	150.00	14 Mar 2024	Parash Jain
Price 7	190.00	03 May 2024	Parash Jain
Price 8	240.00	10 May 2024	Parash Jain
Price 9	210.00	17 Jul 2024	Parash Jain
Price 10	220.00	13 Aug 2024	Parash Jain
Price 11	190.00	08 Oct 2024	Parash Jain
Price 12	200.00	13 Nov 2024	Parash Jain
Price 13	215.00	13 Mar 2025	Parash Jain
Price 14	270.00	12 May 2025	Parash Jain
Price 15	175.00	24 Jun 2025	Parash Jain
Price 16	170.00	13 Aug 2025	Parash Jain

Source: HSBC

To view a list of all the independent fundamental ratings/recommendations disseminated by HSBC during the preceding 12-month period, and the location where we publish our quarterly distribution of non-fundamental recommendations (applicable to Fixed Income and Currencies research only), please use the following links to access the disclosure page:

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HSBC & Analyst disclosures

Disclosure checklist

Company	Ticker	Recent price	Price date	Disclosure
EVERGREEN MARINE	2603.TW	207.50	13 Mar 2026	7

Source: HSBC

- 1 HSBC has managed or co-managed a public offering of securities for this company within the past 12 months.
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